

enough to wear and is aesthetically appealing, as per your individual taste.

There is also the timepiece-redundancy factor to consider. Many activity trackers double as wristwatches.

Sensors

Any wristband device or activity tracker works on the basis of sensors inside. Most of these trackers come with a 3-axis accelerometer. Relying on a single sensor might sound incomplete but when paired with the right algorithms, the accelerometer can draw a fairly accurate picture of daytime activity levels and sleep patterns. Some sensors directly touch the skin to measure features like heart rate and temperature.

Sensors work in different ways; like, when you go to sleep, the accelerometer records subtle hand movements to report periods of light sleep, deep sleep and those annoying periods of complete wakefulness. This type of step-and-sleep tracking amounts to table stakes in the fit-tech market, and all trackers in this roundup use accelerometers to one degree or another.

The wristband could also include an optical blood-flow sensor to record the heart rate, and a perspiration monitor and skin-temperature sensor to complement the perspiration monitor in gauging exertion levels. The basic system collects data, squeezes it through a custom algorithm engine and then spits out detailed reports of daily exercise.

Display and software support

The Web interface for viewing data and the display of the wristband device plays an important role here. Many trackers feature a bright organic light emitting diode (OLED) display that shows the current time, steps taken, kilometres covered, calories burned and floors climbed.

When it comes to connectivity, you can wirelessly sync the device over Bluetooth with a variety of smartphones as well as computers

via a USB dongle. This way, by using desktop syncing, you can use the device properly even if you do not own a compatible smartphone.

Wristband devices also provide deeper data dives via a browser interface or mobile app. Bluetooth syncing has improved the ease of doing the work for them. Syncing capability via Bluetooth keeps the data stored instantly for fitness goals, along with keeping track of calls and alerts.

GPS trackers

A GPS tracking unit uses the global positioning system to determine the precise location of a vehicle, person or other asset to which it is attached, and to record the position of the asset at regular intervals. The built-in GPS tracker in many wristband devices allows the user to set pace and elevation climbed during workouts.

The GPS platform supports thousands of trackers through a single interface. Users can choose from lightweight, battery-powered or portable trackers that can be plugged in a car's onboard diagnostics (OBD) port or hard-wired trackers.

Choose one that fits your budget

A number of wristband devices are available in the market with effective features. You can choose from various options, with designs that make the wristband truly worth wearing.

The final verdict

While making the final decision, you also need to check if the device is water-resistant or waterproof.

With regards to battery life, some devices offer a long battery life that lasts between seven to ten days, while others last for about four days, on a single charge.

If you are still not sure about which device to buy, ask yourself questions like: Will I wear this device every day? Is it compatible with my phone? What do I know about the software interface? Does the device match my fashion sense? ●

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Anand Nagar MIDC, Ambarnath (E) 421 506, MH, India.

Telefax: +91-251-2620-4177/2620427 Cell: +91 98 203 62980

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